MIL-C-44339
17 June 1988
SUPERSEDING
HHH-C-002167A(Army-GL)
August 6, 1985

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CORN, SWEET, CREAM STYLE, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers cream-style, sweet corn thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

TT-C-495	- Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8915

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Cothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Canned Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of specifications, standards, and handbooks required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables, Processed Products Thereof, and Certain Other Processed Food Products

United States Standards for Grades of Canned Cream Style Corn

United States Standard for Grades of Frozen Whole Kernel or Whole Grain Corn

(Copies may be obtained from the Director, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2077, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies may be obtained from the Chairman, Condition of Food Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 0610, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies may be obtained from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, Washington, DC 20460.)

(Copies of drawings, publications, and other Government documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Copies should be obtained from the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Copies should be obtained from the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3330 - Peel Adhesion of Pressure-sensitive Tape

(Copies should be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.2).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Corn. Corn shall be fresh or frozen in accordance with 3.2.1.1 or 3.2.1.2, as applicable. The moisture content of the fresh or frozen corn shall be not less than 68 percent nor more than 71 percent as determined in accordance with the methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Vegetable Products Processed, Paragraph: Solids (Total) in Canned Vegetables.

3.2.1.1 Corn, fresh. Fresh corn shall be succulent, mature, and of a single sweet yellow variety suitable for canning. The corn shall be of such a quality to meet end item requirements.

3.2.1.2 Corn, frozen. Frozen corn shall be U.S. Grade B or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Whole Kernel or Whole Grain Corn and shall be of the latest season's crop.

3.2.2 Water. Water used for formulation and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.3 Sugar. Sugar shall be white, refined, sucrose, granulated cane or beet or a combination of both and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.4 Starch, modified, high opacity. The high opacity starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified maize food starch for use in canned foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140° to 170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. The starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress and conditions of cold storage. The starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.5 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents.

3.3 Preparation and processing.

3.3.1 Corn preparation.

3.3.1.1 Fresh corn preparation. The fresh corn ears shall be husked, silked, cooled, sorted and washed. The corn kernels shall be cut from the ears and the ears scraped to remove the remaining portion of the kernels from the cob. The cutter knives shall be adjusted to cut the kernels approximately in half.

3.3.1.2 Frozen corn preparation. The frozen corn shall be thawed prior to grinding.

3.3.2 Creamed corn preparation. The required percentage of corn kernels (see 3.3.3) together with the corn scrapings shall be mechanically ground through a comminuter to form a smooth, semi-liquid creamy portion.

3.3.3 Cream style corn preparation. The cream style corn shall be prepared from the following ingredients:

Ingredients	Percent
Corn kernels (not ground)	39.0
Water 1/	32.0
Creamed corn	22.0
Sugar	4.3
Starch, modified 2/	1.7
Salt 3/	1.0

1/ The percent of water shall be adjusted appropriately depending on the maturity of the corn utilized to meet the consistency requirement of the finished product (see 3.6).

2/ The percent of starch shall be adjusted appropriately to meet the consistency requirement of the finished product (see 3.6).

3/ The total amount of salt in the formula shall be adjusted as necessary to produce a product that complies with the finished product salt requirements.

a. The whole kernel corn, creamed corn, sugar, salt, and approximately 75 percent of the water shall be heated to 180° to 190°F with proper agitation.

b. A thin slurry shall be prepared from the remaining water and the modified starch using a high speed mixer.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

c. The starch slurry shall be added to the corn mixture and the entire contents heated to 190°F and held for approximately 5 minutes.

d. The product shall be maintained in the temperature range of 150° to 180°F and filled into the tray pack cans within 2 hours after preparation.

e. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted with water immediately before filling to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with cream style corn such as to conform to the finished product requirements (see 3.6) and to the following requirements:

a. There shall be a headspace of at least 1/4 inch after filling.

b. Each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum established by a processing authority and specified in the scheduled process so as to ensure compliance with finished product requirement (see 3.6.h).

c. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after sealing.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (Fo) of not less than 5.0 has been achieved. The filled and sealed thermoprocessed tray pack cans shall show no evidence of can swelling when tested for commercial sterility as specified in 4.5.3.4.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, paint, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

e. No individual can shall have a net weight of less than 104 ounces.

f. The finished product shall be U.S. Grade A in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Cream Style Corn.

g. No individual can shall have a salt content of less than 0.5 percent or greater than 1.5 percent.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

h. Filled, sealed, and retorted cans shall show evidence of proper vacuum as determined by concavity of the can lid (see 4.5.6).

i. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110, "Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Processing, Packaging or Holding of Human Foods," and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to any identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.5.3.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.3.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table I. The tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be heated for 15 minutes in boiling water, opened, and inspected for the defects listed in table II.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 3,200	8	--	0	2
	8	16	1	2
3,201 to 35,000	13	--	0	3
	13	26	3	4

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Not grade specified. 3/
102	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

1/ The presence of foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparision shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agent.)

3/ The product shall be U.S. Grade A in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Cream Style Corn and inspected in accordance with the provisions of the Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables, Processed Products Thereof, and certain other Processed Food Products.

4.5.3.3 Salt content testing. Nine tray packs shall be selected from the lot and distributed as follows:

- Three for laboratory analysis
- Three for submission to the contractor
- Three for retention by the AMS agent as reserve samples.

The three tray packs for laboratory analysis shall be individually tested for salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. Preparation of the sample shall be as follows. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. If the salt content of any individual tray pack is less than 0.5 percent or greater than 1.5 percent, it is a major defect and the lot shall be rejected.

Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analyses indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the salt requirement. When reserve samples are analyzed, the analyses shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in the same or subsequent lots.

4.5.3.4 Commercial sterility testing. The sample size shall be one filled, sealed, and thermoprocessed tray pack can selected from each retort batch in the lot. The sample cans shall be tested for sterility by incubating the cans at 95° ± 5°F for 10 days. Any evidence of can swelling shall be considered a critical defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with 4.5.4.1.

4.5.4.1 Can label examination. Labels shall be examined for defects in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4) except that for self-adhering labels the following additional defects shall apply:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Major: Labels torn or scratched so as to obliterate any of the markings.

Minor: Air bubbles under label.
Label not properly adhered to can, i.e, label raised or peeled back from edges or corners.

4.5.4.2 Label adhesive examination. When self-adhering labels are used, the adhesive shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 3330.

4.5.5 Can closure examination. Can closure shall be examined visually and by teardowns in accordance with the can manufacturer's requirement and CFR 21, Part 113, Subpart D. Any nonconformance based on observation of can seam teardowns or of any record of can seam teardowns is a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of any involved product.

4.5.6 Vacuum examination. Cans shall be allowed to cool to 75° ± 5°F, held for at least 24 hours after thermoprocessing, and then examined for vacuum retention. To examine, lay a straight edge in the center of the lid along the length of the tray pack. Both ends of the straight edge shall touch the lid at the inside edge of the double seam. There shall be a visible gap between the straight edge and the lid for the entire distance of the label panel. Using a shorter straight edge, the same procedure shall be used across the width, in the center of the tray pack can. When examining a ribbed lid, only lay the straight edge between the two center ribs along the length of the can. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in a single shift on a single sealing machine. The sample size shall be 50 cans. Any nonconformance is a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified.
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.5.8 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 106 ounces of food product, sealed, and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall neither affect nor be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.1.1 When specified (see 6.1), the base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 98 pounds per base box. The body design shall be reinforced on the bottom with six longitudinal beads or ribs 0.050 ± 0.010 inch deep. The beads shall be 9 inches by 3/4 inch in length and width and shall be equidistant in the center panel of the bottom. The end design shall be reinforced with eight longitudinal beads 0.018 ± 0.004 inch deep. The beads shall be 11 inches by 3/4 inch in length and width and shall be equidistant in the center panel of the end. The center four beads on the end design shall be interrupted to provide a 5-inch by 5-inch flat center panel for labeling. The apex of all these beads shall be outward. The interior and exterior can coating requirements shall be as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be preserved as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L or HSC-L with an HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1), except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified, except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load, with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and with the following:

- Official establishment number (e.g., EST 38) or a three-digit letter code identifying the establishment
- Lot number 1/
- Production shift number 1/
- Retort identification number 1/
- Retort cook number 1/

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four-digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year (for example, March 19, 1987, would be coded as 7078). The Julian code shall represent the day the product was packaged and processed. Sub-lotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four digit Julian code. Following the four-digit Julian code and the alpha character (when used), the other required code information shall be printed in the sequence as listed above.

Alternatively, a preprinted self-adhering 0.002-inch thick clear polyester label printed with indelible black ink may be used. Self-adhering labels shall be applied after retorting. Pressure-sensitive adhesive shall require no preparation prior to application. Labels shall tack quickly and adhere without curling or breaking. The adhesive shall have a minimum adhesion of 60 ounces per inch width when examined as specified in 4.5.4.2. In addition, the name of the product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall remain legible when examined as specified in 4.5.4 after preparation of product in accordance with heating instructions. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently for 15 minutes. Avoid overheating (can shows evidence of bulging).

CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place. Place in a 350°F oven for 35 - 40 minutes.

WARNING: Do not place unopened can in oven. This may cause the can to burst.

YIELD: For Army Field Feeding, serves 18 portions of 3/4 cup each. For other uses, serves 25 portions of 1/2 cup each.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, when tray pack cans are fabricated from 90 pounds per base box, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT
OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE,
UNLESS PALLET RACKS ARE USED.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).
d. Level of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. When tray pack cans are to be fabricated from 98 pounds per base box (see 5.1.1.1).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned foods
Corn
Rations
Thermostabilized
Tray pack

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8915-0820

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the *DoD* provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

US Army Natick Research, Development, and
Engineering Center
Natick, MA 01760-5014

NO POSTAGE
NECESSARY
IF MAILED
IN THE
UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300
STRNC-ES

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 12062 WASHINGTON D. C.
POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

Commander
US Army Natick Research, Development,
and Engineering Center
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Box 14A
Natick, MA 01760-5014

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-44339	Corn, Sweet, Cream Style, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.